



Post-it note

Created by American company 3M, the **POST-IT NOTE** allows you to attach notes to most surfaces without leaving a mark. *The same note can be used repeatedly* since only some of the glue bubbles on the adhesive strip pop each time. The Post-it went on sale in the United States in 1980 before **going global**.

↪ The world's largest paper clip stood 30 ft (9 m) in height.

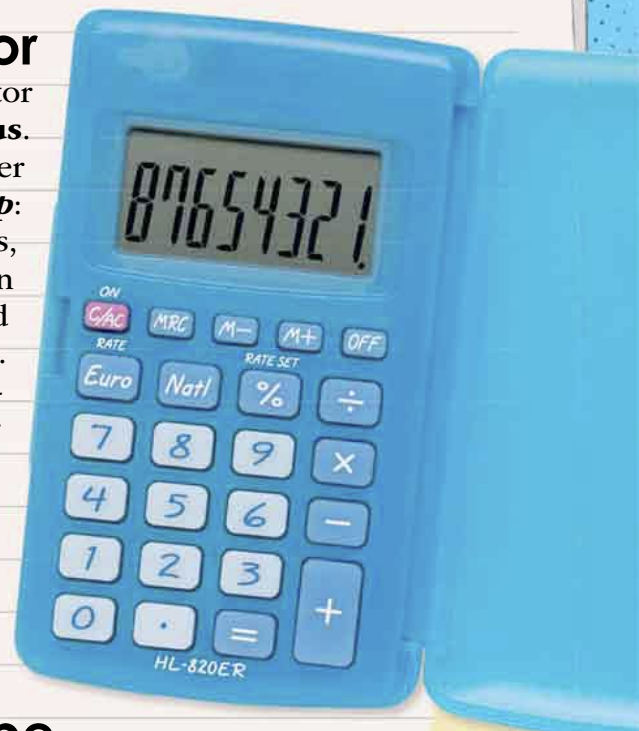
Pocket calculator

The early equivalent of the calculator was a counting device called an **abacus**.

Mechanical calculators developed over time, *but something didn't add up*:

They were slow, bulky machines, operated by hand cranks. American company Texas Instruments developed the first handheld calculator in 1967.

By the 1970s, calculators were pocket-sized—**GREAT GADGETS** for number-crunching students and office workers.



Sticky tape

Another employee of 3M, Richard Drew, developed **sticky tape** in 1930 after researching adhesives and the material cellophane. The transparent tape coincided with a huge **ECONOMIC DOWNTURN** in the United States. Consumers welcomed a product that *fixed their household* goods when new ones were unaffordable.

Every year, more than six million rolls of sticky tape are sold just before Christmas.